

SWK501

Proctored Online Exam - January Semester 2025

Human Lifespan and Social Ecology

**Saturday, 19 April 2025
pm**

10:00 am - 01:00

Time allowed: 3 hours

INSTRUCTIONS TO STUDENTS:

1. This examination contains **THREE (3) questions**.
2. **Answer all questions.**
3. All answers must be typed in the answer box and submitted in Examena.
4. This is a **Closed-book** examination.
5. To prevent plagiarism and collusion, your submission will be reviewed by Turnitin. The Turnitin report will only be made available to the marker and you will not be able to view it.
6. The University takes plagiarism and collusion seriously, and your Turnitin report will be examined thoroughly as part of the marking process.

At the end of the examination.

To end the examination, please click on the "Submit and end exam" button to submit your answers.

**THE UNIVERSITY RESERVES THE RIGHT NOT TO MARK YOUR
SCRIPT IF YOU FAIL TO FOLLOW THESE INSTRUCTIONS.**

(Full marks: 100)

Answer ALL questions. (100 marks)

Answer all questions in this section.

Question 1

It was reported that four male adolescents had been caught stealing in a neighbourhood mall shop. They were handed over to the police.

Three of the adolescents, all aged 16 years, were dropouts of a school nearby. The fourth, aged 14 years, was a Secondary 2 student still studying in the same school. His name was Max (not his real name).

The police investigator handling the case discovered from Max's school report that he was a quiet and polite secondary 1 student. At that point in time, Max studied hard and was doing well in some subjects. He was also rather good in sports, and earned good comments from his teachers.

During the first term of the second year, Max started to grow quickly in size and looked different. He became physically stronger, talked loudly, and was more active.

Towards the later part of the term, Max's behaviours started to become problematic. He was frequently late and even absent from some classes. He failed to submit his homework and did poorly in his tests. The form teacher had discussions with him a few times, trying to understand him and advised him to pay more attention to his studies, but it was in vain. He did not change.

The teacher had no choice but to contact his parents who were too busy to come to school. Eventually, she decided to make a home visit at night to understand Max's behaviours better. The teacher found out that both parents (father - a delivery driver; mother - a hawker assistant) worked long hours and often came home late. They felt bad about not spending enough time with Max. As a result, Max had a lot of free time after school and tended to have lunch and dinner at a nearby hawker centre. This gave him chances to mix around with other adolescents including the three dropouts mentioned above in the neighbourhood. Long hours of working deprived the parents of their time to interact with, and understand, their son.

Some of Max's classmates had alerted the form teacher that they had noticed him mixing with other adolescents and playing games in the field. He was also found talking loudly, smoking and drinking with his gang of friends at the void deck. The gang would shout loudly at times. Their unruly behaviours annoyed the residents.

In the second term, Max became less disciplined and had more arguments with his classmates. This was the time when he was arrested for stealing.

Based on the detailed information provided in this case, answer the following questions:

Question 1a

From the development perspective, identify, analyse and discuss five (5) factors that were likely to affect Max's development and involvement in delinquent activities. Support your answers with research studies and examples.

(30 marks)

Question 1b

Choose and evaluate a theory that you think is the most applicable to explain Max's behaviour. Give reasons for your selection.

(10 marks)

Question 1c

Formulate an intervention programme (individual, group or both) that would help Max change his behaviour. Defend the design of this programme using the dual-focus approach you have learnt in this course. Provide research studies to support your points.

(20 marks)

Question 2

Citing appropriate research studies and local examples, appraise and discuss the development of cognition and intelligence in middle adulthood. After which, examine the emergence of 'wisdom' among midlife adults.

(20 marks)

Question 3

With reference to research studies and appropriate example, hypothesise how the "selective optimisation with compensation (SOC) model" can contribute to successful aging among the older adults. Formulate one (1) activity for older adults, which illustrates the SOC model for a community centre in a Singapore neighbourhood.

(20 marks)

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